FOR THE STATE — THE SOVEREIGN BRIEF

THE ABSENCE AUDIT — THE METHOD, AT NATIONAL SCALE

Tunisia, audited — the state program, complete

The Fed transmission measured, the program architecture, the instruments, the financing, the gates, the signature path — every line cited.

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1. The Fed transmission — measured, not restated

World Bank API, measured 2026-09-09 (Pg1): external debt **$40.46B**, **78.7% of GDP**; debt service **26.2% of export revenues**; reserves **$9.34B** = 4.3 months of imports; food $3.00B + fuel $4.90B of imports; CA -1.5% of GDP; growth 2.5%, inflation 5.2% (2025).

Channel 1 — the debt trap: the “original sin” (Pg12) — no long-term borrowing in the dinar abroad — exposes the state to the Fed cycle (Pg13): Fed hikes lift global yields, refinancing turns expensive, and the 26.2% of export revenues that debt service absorbs compounds while reserves (4.3 months) drain.

Channel 2 — imported inflation: the rate differential pulls capital to US safe assets, the dinar depreciates, and the dollar invoice on food ($3.00B) and fuel ($4.90B) inflates. The BCT — autonomous, non-monetizing under Organic Law 2016-35 (Pg4/Pg5) — must hold rates to defend the dinar: correct orthodoxy, strangled growth.

The loop’s answer: owned export engines earn ~$117M/yr of gross exports outside the Fed cycle; the substitution legs take $152M/yr out of the dollar invoice directly; reserves rise, the rating runs B-/Caa1 → BB-, and the refinancing premium shrinks for the state with its own hard-currency engines. Not defiance of the Fed — independence from the channel.

2. The state program — architecture, instruments, financing, adoption

Counterparts — who signs what

INSTITUTION	INSTRUMENT	ROLE
GCT (Tunisian Chemical Group)	acid-stream MOU + sampling agreement	the treasury's feedstock
SONEDE	municipal/industrial water offtake at >=$0.68/m3 gate	water contracts under the existing regime
STEG	25-year PPA under the IPP regime (500 MW class)	the power leg's revenue
Ministry of Industry, Mines & Energy	program sponsor; tender registration	the executive mandate
Ministry of Health	biomonitoring + cohort registry	the scoreboard

INSTITUTION	INSTRUMENT	ROLE
CNSTN	NORM licensing for the uranium route	the regulatory pass
Ministry of State Domains & Agriculture	40-year leases under Law 93-120 (86,000 ha available)	the land
BCT	reserve/rating path; FX policy coordination	the monetary endgame

Legal instruments — nothing new needs to be invented

INSTRUMENT	WHAT IT PROVIDES	CITATION
Organic Law 2016-35 (BCT)	monetary autonomy; the program does NOT monetize	Pg4/Pg5
IPP regime — Law 2015-62 & 2024/25 awards	renewables concessions; ~$31/MWh PPAs; 500 MW precedent	Rc13
PPP framework — Law 2015-49	desal/metals as PPPs where the state is the offtaker	Pg2
Law 93-120 (state-domain leases)	40-year agricultural leases; ~86,000 ha earmarked	Rc19
NORM/radiological regime (CNSTN, IAEA standards)	the uranium route's license layer	Pg11/Rm12

Financing stack — staged, gated, modeled in code

STAGE	FINANCING	GATE / CONDITION
Phase 0 ($150-253k)	grant / founder / early mandate	no DFI needed; 90 days
Health pilot ($58k)	ESG/grant	the first scoreboard numbers
Metals plant (~$100M)	60% debt @7% + offtake security; MIGA	DSCR >=1.2 at contract prices (nations_v5)
Solar (500 MW, ~$550M)	DFI stack: EIB/AfDB/WB-IFC at 4.5% + MIGA; or lean build	DSCR gate inside the bankable region (nations_v5)
Desal (~$165M)	70% debt @6% + municipal offtake + sovereign backstop	blended >=$0.68/m3, >=60% pre-sold
Terfas + food ($7-35M)	concessional agri + founder	nursery first
EU Global Gateway (17 GW)	the national envelope this program plugs into	Pg7

Governance

- every gate is a public number — published, dated, re-checkable
- health fund separate from the industrial SPVs; one shared data platform
- quarterly scoreboard: water chemistry, filter uptime, cohort KPIs, price index in Gafsa/Gabes
- each pilot passes or dies alone, in public — the falsification ladder is the governance
- commercially-validated ledger published at zero until the first signature moves it

Adoption path — what the state signs, in order

1. **Month 0:** the state signs: GCT sampling MOU + Phase 0 mandate ($150-250k, 90 days, no construction)
2. **Day 90:** two anchor measurements land: the 100-point water panel and the acid-stream assays — every projection becomes a signed number
3. **Months 4-18:** pilots on public gates: acid pilot, 100 ha terfas + nursery, spirulina pond, solar bid, desal offtake, health KPIs
4. **Years 2-5:** build only what passed: metals, solar, desal, health at basin scale — module by module, each with its own financing
5. **Years 5-10+:** the full loop: municipal spine, compute colocation, hydrogen, brine valorization — the destination the original design described

3. What the state receives

External account: ~$279M/yr of exports + import substitution + financing delta at full phase — measured against the 26.2% of export revenues that debt service takes today. **Rating path:** B-/Caa1 → BB- and reserves 4.5 → 6+ months as the owned-export engines compound (Rc11). **Health scoreboard:** the basin's water chemistry, DALY ledger and filter uptime become public KPIs — the collateral that lowers the price of every loan. **Jobs:** workshop, nursery, ponds, plants, solar crews, health workers — in the towns where the 2008 and 2015 blockades began. A job is the cheapest peace treaty ever signed.

4. The gates are public — the state sees every number

MODULE	GATE	PASSES ON
Health pilot (100 households, 2 schools, 90 days)	filter uptime ≥70%, urinary F ↓20%	public KPIs
Metals pilot	U recovery ≥85%, all-in ≤$75/lb, offtake signed	GCT stream
Solar	DSCR ≥1.15 inside the bankable region, or grant support	PPA award
Desalination	≥60% contracted offtake, blended ≥$0.68/m³	brine permit
Terfas	3-season record ≥200 kg/ha at ≥€20/kg; quota clause signed	scaling toward 2,000-3,000 ha

5. Phase 0 — what the 90 days produce for the state

Two anchor measurements — the 100-point water panel and the acid-stream assays ($75k of the $253k list) — plus the emissions inventory. Every projection on this page becomes a signed number before one brick is laid. Nothing is asked of the state beyond cooperation, and every gate is a number the state can check.

What this document is: a concept-level engineering design whose numbers are computed in code from sourced primitives — recomputed, corrected, and applied into the design. Free and public.

What it is not: a commissioned state program, a bank-grade feasibility study, an investment offer, or a claim that any of this has been built. Nothing here is advice to any government or any investor. Nothing replaces geological, radiological, geotechnical or EPC-level surveys. Verify every figure and citation before relying on any of it.

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